



First Turn Guide

Updated terms and decisions for the illustrated battle example.

Current as of 24 September 2026

This page updates the reference pages that follow. Where older wording differs, use this revision until the full canonical card-file migration is approved.

Read the example with current terms

- Every Level label on the following illustrated pages means Catalyst Rank. Kuroneko is Rank 3; Vash is Rank 4. Rank 1-4 needs no Tribute for a Normal Spawn, Rank 5-6 needs one, and Rank 7+ needs two.
- Both 1v1 players begin with 10,000 Chi and five cards. Player 1 draws but skips the first Battle Phase. A team shares a single 10,000 Chi pool in team play.

Resolve the turn

- Pressure beating a non-Great Catalyst's Counter Pressure captures it in the Box without Chi damage. A Great Catalyst that would be captured goes to the Void and awards a Kill instead.
- A successful Special Spawn makes the opponent draw one before on-Spawn effects; a whole Libra Spawn counts once. No more than five successful Special Spawns per turn.
- At End Phase choose Extract, Rescue, Destroy 1 Trick, or Pass Turn. A paid choice needs a Catalyst you own and control, even if newly Spawned. Pass Turn is free.

Then try your own FORGE

- Create three Normal Catalysts, one Great Fusion Catalyst, and one Trick. FORGE -> TEST -> DISCOVER -> REFINE -> FORGE AGAIN. Review each scenario with Continue or Go Back.



PLAYER 1 / FIRST TURN

BUILD THE FIRST FLAME

You go first. Draw, establish a safe field, and remember that your first Battle Phase is skipped.

OPENING HAND

5 cards

DRAW PHASE

Draw to 6

BATTLE

Skipped

STARTING CHI

10,000

1

TURN START

Ready the turn

Confirm Player 1 is active. Both players began with 5 cards and 10,000 Chi.

2

DRAW

Draw exactly 1

Player 1 draws on Turn 1, so the example hand grows from 5 cards to 6.

3

IGNITION

Resolve automatic effects

Refresh continuous cards and resolve effects that specifically trigger here.

4

ACTION

Set Kuroneko

Use the one Normal action to Set Level 3 Kuroneko face-down in Defense. No Tribute is needed.

5

ACTION

Play a proactive Trick

Activate Claim Your Bounty from hand. It waits for a Vash card to go from the field to the Void.

6

BATTLE

Do not attack

Player 1 cannot conduct the first Battle Phase of the duel. Continue to Resolution.

7

RESOLUTION + END

Pass Turn

Finish effects, check wins, choose Pass Turn, and discard only if the hand is above 7.

Kuroneko

TG1-107



EARTH / BEAST / EFFECT

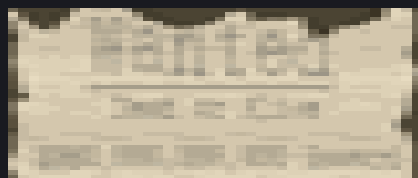
LEVEL 3

P 500 CP 1000

When destroyed and sent to the Void, Special Spawn 1 Kuroneko from your Deck, then shuffle.

Claim Your Bounty

TG1-001



PALM TRICK / CONTINUOUS

Each time a Catalyst with Vash in its name goes from the field to the Void, you may draw 2 cards.

EXAMPLE BOARD AFTER PLAYER 1

Kuroneko is face-down in a Catalyst Zone, Claim Your Bounty is face-up, and Player 1 keeps every remaining card in hand. Pass Turn costs nothing.



PLAYER 2 / FIRST TURN

NOW BATTLE OPENS

Player 2 follows the same seven phases, but may enter Battle and challenge Player 1's setup.

OPENING HAND

5 cards

DRAW PHASE

Draw to 6

BATTLE

Available

STARTING CHI

10,000

1

TURN START

Player 2 becomes active

Ready Player 2's cards and begin the first full turn with Battle available.

2

DRAW

Draw exactly 1

Player 2's opening hand grows from 5 cards to 6.

3

IGNITION

Resolve automatic effects

Refresh continuous cards and follow any printed Ignition timing.

4

ACTION

Normal Spawn Vash

Level 4 Vash enters in Pressure position with no Tribute: P 1800 / CP 1300.

5

BATTLE

Attack the Set Catalyst

Vash attacks. Kuroneko flips face-up, so Vash's P 1800 is compared with Kuroneko's CP 1000.

6

RESOLUTION

Capture Kuroneko

P is greater than CP: move Kuroneko to Player 2's Box. This causes no Chi damage.

7

END

Choose, then clean up

Pass Turn to keep Vash, or pay for one legal End action. Discard only above 7 cards.

Vash

TG1-102



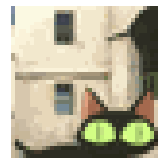
LIGHT / WARRIOR / GUNMAN / EFFECT

LEVEL 4

P 1800 CP 1300

If a face-up Knives Catalyst is on the field, Special Spawn Vash - The Legendary Gunman from hand or Deck.

BATTLE RESULT / CAPTURE



KURONEKO

>

BOX

P2 CAPTURE

P 1800 beats CP 1000: no Chi damage; no Void trigger.

IMPORTANT END PHASE CHOICE

Vash is newly Spawned, but Player 2 owns and controls it, so Vash may pay for Extract. This example uses Pass Turn instead. A borrowed opponent Catalyst could never pay.



SPECIAL RULES / EXEMPTIONS

REMEMBER THESE EIGHT

These are the rules that most often change an otherwise normal-looking play.

1 FIRST TURN + SPAWN MATH

Player 1 draws, but skips the duel's first Battle Phase. Normal Spawn/Set: Level 1-4 costs 0 Tributes; Level 5-6 costs 1; Level 7+ costs 2.

2 SHOTGUN RULE

Every Special Spawn makes the opponent draw 1. A whole Libra Spawn counts as one Special Spawn and one Shotgun draw. Maximum: 5 Special Spawns per turn.

3 END PHASE OWNERSHIP

Extract, Rescue, or Destroy 1 Trick uses a Catalyst you own and control. Newly Spawned is legal. Opponent-owned is never legal. Pass Turn is free.

4 GREAT CARDS

One copy per name. Maximum 5 Great cards in the Standard Deck plus 5 Great Fusion Catalysts. Great Catalysts cannot enter the Box or be Extracted.

5 BATTLE OUTCOMES

P beats P: Kill to Void plus Chi difference. P beats CP: Capture to Box, no Chi damage. If P is lower than CP: no Capture; attacker loses the difference in Chi.

6 DIRECT ATTACKS

You may attack Chi directly only when all 5 opposing Catalyst Zones are empty. Trick cards and Libra scales do not block a direct attack.

7 DECK + HAND EXEMPTIONS

Start with 5 and draw on Player 1's first turn. An empty Deck skips the draw; deck-out is not a loss. End Phase hand limit: 7.

8 WIN CHECK PRIORITY

Win immediately at 0 Chi, 7 battle Kills, or 7 Extractions. If multiple conditions happen together, check in this order: Chi KO, Kills, Extractions.



Ambush

TG1-022 / CONCEALED TRICK

Destroy an attacking Catalyst and remove it from play.



2nd Wind

TG1-023 / PALM TRICK / EQUIP

COST: 500 CHI

Special Spawn 1 LIGHT Catalyst from your Void in Pressure position and equip this card to it.



Vash - Great Fighter Of Peace

TG1-024 / LIGHT / WARRIOR / GUN

P 2400 CP 2000

Special Spawn only with Fighter Of Peace. Gains P and CP for Vash cards in your Void (restricted to 2).